

Identity Work Handout

The Identity I Inherited, Built, and Can Rebuild

My past explains parts of me. It does not get final authority over me.

Name the old identity below without romanticizing it, shaming it, or letting it decide what happens next.

You are more than the worst thing you did, the label someone gave you, or the coping skill that once kept you alive. Behavior is hard to sustain when the story underneath still says, “I am broken.” Identity work starts with a different question: who did you become in order to survive, and who do you choose to practice becoming now?

Three Working Sections

1. THE LABEL I CARRY

What names, labels, or beliefs about myself have I accepted as permanent?

List the exact words. Note which ones you still defend or repeat to yourself.

2. WHAT THAT IDENTITY PROTECTED

What pain, fear, loss, or danger did this identity help me survive?

Name the function, not the story. What did it keep away or make feel inevitable?

Grounding note: Name the function in a few words. You do not need to tell the whole story here. If this brings up more than you expected, pause and bring it to session rather than writing through it alone.

3. THE IDENTITY I PRACTICE NOW

What values and daily actions would prove I am becoming someone different?

Choose 1 to 2 values. Attach 1 to 3 small, repeatable actions that create new evidence this week.

Bridge prompt: For each value, name one action that a person who still believed the label in Section 1 would not do. That contrast is the evidence.

Progression: Label to New Evidence

This is a simple sequence, not a before-and-after. Agency sits in the middle. Evidence closes it.

1. **Label** — The name that stuck.

2. **Survival Role** — The function it served.
3. **Cost** — What it still takes from you.
4. **Choice** — What would it cost to keep defending this label, and what do you get if it becomes old evidence instead of current truth?
5. **Practice** — Daily evidence generators.
6. **New Evidence** — What replaces the old story.

Work With Broken Halo

Broken Halo Institute exists to challenge the idea that recovery is only about stopping a behavior. Lasting change also means understanding the identity built around survival, addiction, shame, and the stories people learned to believe about themselves.

The work combines lived experience with practical recovery principles to create resources, conversations, and training that are direct, usable, and grounded in dignity without avoiding accountability.

Interested in collaboration, speaking, training, or using Broken Halo resources in your organization? [GET IN TOUCH](#)

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Non-negotiable boundary: This is an educational resource — not a treatment provider, not emergency care, not a source of diagnosis, and not a counselor–client relationship.